



WHEN

December 19, 2025
Pot Luck Dinner (No lecture)
Doors open at 6:00pm
Dinner starts at 7:00pm

WHERE

Unitarian Church
1893 North Vasco Road
Livermore, CA 945571
and via Zoom

TVS QR CODE



INSIDE THIS ISSUE

News and Notes	2
Calender of Events	2
TVS Astrophotography	3-4
What's Up	5
Navigating the Night Sky - December 2025	6
Navigating the Morning Sky - December 2025	7
Membership / Renewal Application	8

NEWS AND NOTES

Meeting Dates

Club Meeting	Board Meeting	PrimeFocus Deadline
December 19	December 22	December 6
January 3	January 16	January 19
February 20	February 23	February 7

Money Matters

As of the last Treasurer's Report on 11/24/25, our club's account balance is \$49,984.83, this includes \$12,705.46 in the H2O Rebuild fund.

TVS Welcomes New Members

TVS welcomes new members Maya Thomas, Balachandar Ravichandran, Vrashuly Shinglot, Emry Dickerson Santana, Ashwin Singh, and Lindsey Smith. Please say hello and chat with them during our meetings.

2025 TVS Club Star Party Schedule

Save the dates for the 2025 Club Star Parties. Del Valle star parties are also public outreach events. They are jointly hosted with the EBRPD and held at the Arroyo Staging Area (Coords: 37.6196638, -121.7528899). The public is invited for the first 1.5-2 hours, while club members can stay the remainder of the night.

No events currently scheduled for Del Valle.

Tesla Vintners star parties are open to only club members and their guests. These star parties end at midnight, but participants can leave earlier, should they wish.

No events currently scheduled for Tesla Vintners.

H2O Open House star parties are open to only club members and their guests. The open house ends at midnight, and all participants are encouraged to stay the duration. The drive to H2O takes about 1 hour, and the caravan leaves promptly from the corner of Mines and Tesla Rds. No gas stations are available on the route, so be prepared. Admission is \$3/car-bring exact change. H2O is a primitive site with two porta-potties. Bring water, food, and warm clothing, as needed. Red flashlights are to be used so observers can preserve their night vision.

No events currently scheduled for H2O.

January 14: School Star Party Lawrence Elementary School, 2451 Portola Ave, Livermore, CA 94551. Set-up 5:15pm, Observing from 6:00-7:30pm.

CALENDAR OF EVENTS



November 21, 22, 28,29, December 5, 6, 12,13, 19, 20, 7:30-10:30pm

What	Free Telescope Viewing
Who	Chabot Staff
Where	Chabot Space and Science Center, 10000 Skyline Blvd. Oakland, CA 94619
Cost	Free

Join Chabot astronomers on the Observatory Deck for a free telescope viewing! Weather permitting, this is a chance to explore stars, planets and more through Chabot's historic telescopes. Chabot's three large historic telescopes offer a unique way to experience the awe and wonder of the Universe. Three observatory domes house the Center's 8-inch (Leah, 1883) and 20-inch (Rachel, 1916) refracting telescopes, along with a 36-inch reflecting telescope (Nellie, 2003).

Are the skies clear for viewing tonight? Viewing can be impacted by rain, clouds, humidity and other weather conditions. Conditions can be unique to Chabot because of its unique location in Joaquin Miller Park. Before your visit, check out the Weather Station to see the current conditions at Chabot.

For more information, see <https://chabotspace.org/events/events-listing/> <https://eastbayastro.org/chabot-telescope-status/>



November 11, 2025, By Alan B. Gorski. I haven't felt the thrill and excitement of seeing an aurora borealis in years and November 11, 2025 did not disappoint. The local 6 o'clock TV news from Colorado Springs alerted me to this heavenly display. At first, it was just a diffuse glow. I grabbed my tripod and trusty old Canon 50D, that was modified for astrophotography, equipped with a filter identical to the one that was removed, and sat in a lawn chair waiting for the activity to pick up.

I took a lot of shots as the intensity and location shifted from northeast to northwest. The auroral curtains were slow moving and quite diffuse. The attached images show some of the best structure. The attached photos were 5 to 15 seconds, ISO 1600 at f/4 with a Canon L 17- 40mm lens. Note that our eyes (cones) are most sensitive to the green portion of the spectrum, whereas the red, faintly visible, is vivid in these photos. As solar activity "heats up/coronal mass ejections," we may get to see more displays of the aurora in the months and years to come.



Gemind Meteor, By Ken Sperber. December 13, taken from Flagstaff. Canon 6D, 16mm, f/2.8, ISO-3200, 20 sec

WHATS UP

Adapted from Sky and Telescope

All times are Pacific Standard Time

December 2025

20	Sat	New Moon
21	Sun	Longest night of the year
26	Fri	Looking south, Moon is a little less than 3° upper right of Saturn
27	Sat	Moon is at first quarter
31	Wed	At dusk, Moon is just 6½° lower left of the Pleiades

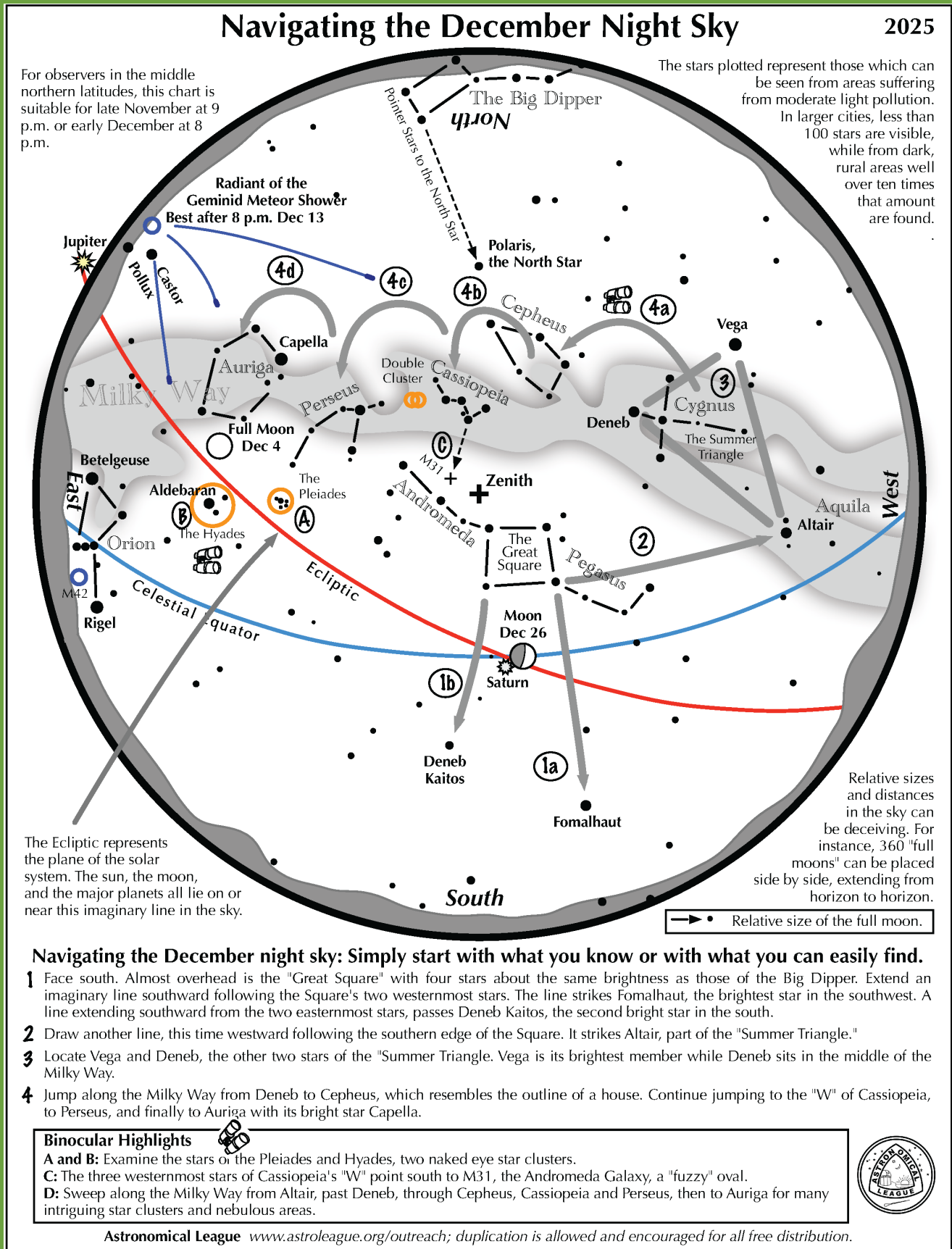
January 2026

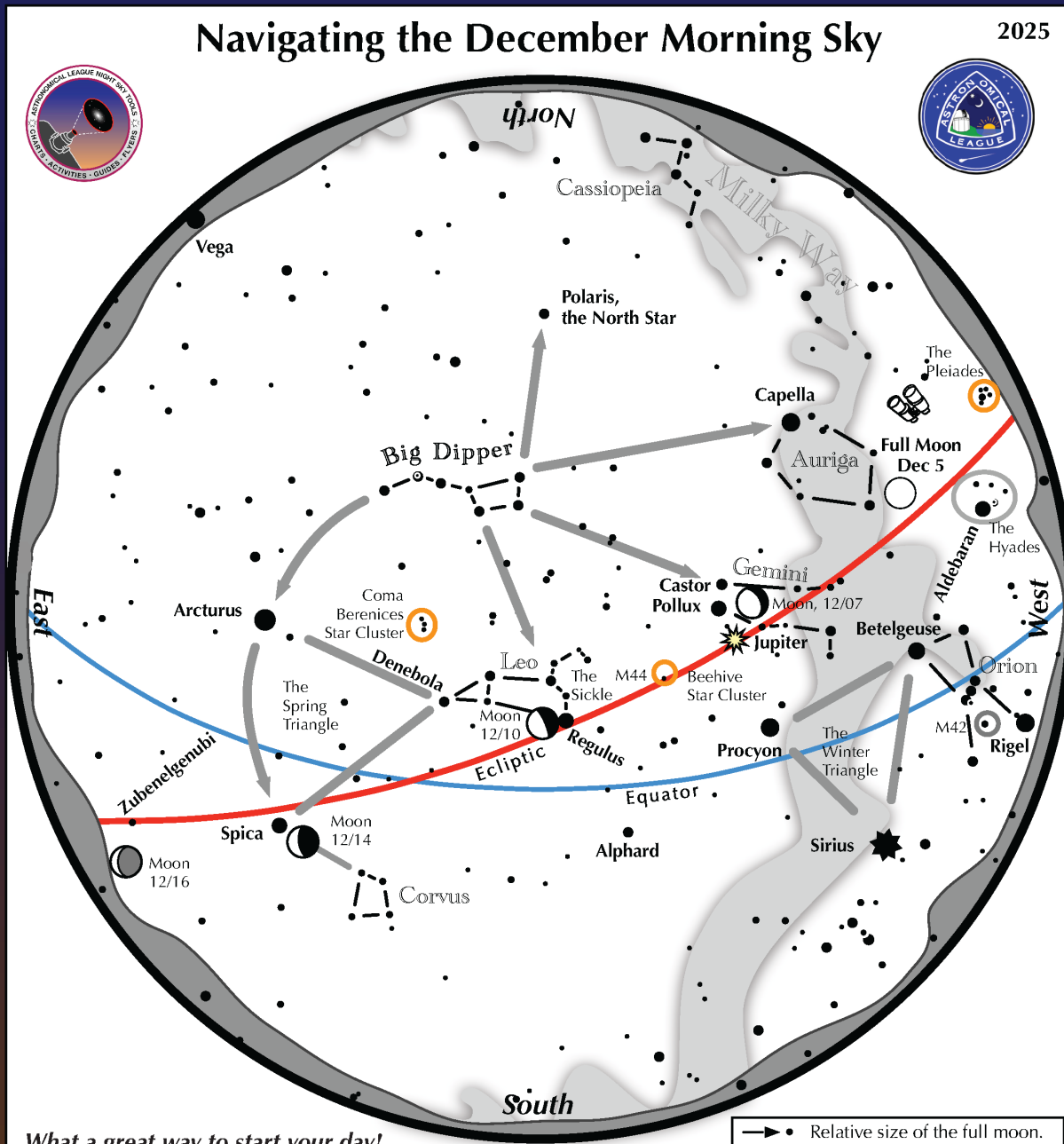
3	Sat	Full Moon , Earth passes through perihelion, its closest point to the Sun for 2026, at around 9:16 AM; At dusk, Moon rise flanked by Pollux about 3¼° to its left and Jupiter about 3° to its right.
3-4	Sat-Sun	The Quadrantid meteor shower is at its peak, but may be dwarfed by the brightness of the Moon
6	Tue	Algol shines at minimum brightness between 8:13 and 10:13 PM
9-10	Fri-Sat	Jupiter is at opposition
10	Sat	Moon is at last quarter
11	Sun	In the morning, Moon is above the east-southeastern horizon where it hangs some 5¼° below Spica
14	Wed	At dawn, looking southeast to see the waning crescent Moon delicately perched 3½° upper right of Antares

OFFICERS AND VOLUNTEER POSITIONS

Officers	Volunteer Positions	Newsletter	Potluck Coordinator
President Eric Dueltgen president@trivalleystargazers.org	Astronomical League Rep. Don Dossa alrep@trivalleystargazers.org	Scott Schneider (Editor) newsletter@trivalleystargazers.org	OPEN potluck@trivalleystargazers.org
Vice-President Aris Pope vice_president@trivalleystargazers.org	Club Star Party Coordinator Johnathan Bailey coordinator@trivalleystargazers.org	Webmaster Swaroop Shere webmaster@trivalleystargazers.org	Program Coordinator Ron Kane programs@trivalleystargazers.org
Treasurer Ernest Epley treasurer@trivalleystargazers.org	Del Valle Coordinator David Wright delvalle@trivalleystargazers.org	Night Sky Network Rep. Ross Gaunt nnsn@trivalleystargazers.org	Publicity and Fundraising OPEN publicity@trivalleystargazers.org
Secretary Dave Lackey secretary@trivalleystargazers.org	Historian OPEN historian@trivalleystargazers.org	H2O Observatory Director / Rebuild Chairman Chuck Grant H2O@trivalleystargazers.org	Refreshment Coordinator OPEN
Past President Ron Kane past_president@trivalleystargazers.org	Librarian Ron Kane librarian@trivalleystargazers.org	Observing Program Coordinator Ron Kane awards@trivalleystargazers.org	Web and Email www.trivalleystargazers.org info@trivalleystargazers.org
	Loaner Scope Manager Ron Kane telescopes@trivalleystargazers.org	Outreach Coordinator Johnathan Bailey outreach@trivalleystargazers.org	TVS E-Group To Join the TVS E-Group just send an email to TVS at info@trivalleystargazers.org asking to join the group. Make sure you specify the email address you want to use to read and post to the group.

NAVIGATING THE NIGHT SKY FOR DECEMBER 2025





What a great way to start your day!

For observers in the middle northern latitudes, this chart is suitable for mid December at 5:00 a.m.

Late sunrises in December provide opportunities for early morning skywatching.

- Bright Jupiter shines high in the west.
- The near third quarter moon floats above Regulus on December 10.
- The waning crescent moon glows next to Spica on December 14.
- The thin crescent moon rises near the double star Zubenelgenubi on December 16.
- A great time for viewing the Big Dipper, Leo, and the Spring Triangle. And, in the second half of the month, it is time for galaxy viewing!

Astronomical League www.astroleague.org; duplication is allowed and encouraged for all free distribution.



Tri-Valley Stargazers
P.O. Box 2476
Livermore, CA 94551
www.trivalleystargazers.org

Tri-Valley Stargazers Membership Application

Contact information:

Name: _____ Phone: _____

Street Address: _____

City, State, Zip: _____

Email Address: _____

Status (select one): _____ New member _____ Renewing or returning member

Membership category (select one): Membership term is for one calendar year, January through December.

_____ Student member (\$10). Must be a full-time high-school or college student.

_____ Regular member (\$30).

Hidden Hill Observatory Access (optional): Must be 18 or older.

_____ One-time key deposit (\$20). This is a refundable deposit for a key to H2O. New key holders must first hear an orientation lecture and sign a usage agreement form before using the observing site.

_____ Annual access fee (\$10). You must also be a key holder to access the site.

Donation (optional):

_____ Tax-deductible contribution to Tri-Valley Stargazers

Total enclosed: \$ _____

Member agrees to hold Tri-Valley Stargazers, and any cooperating organizations or landowners, harmless from all claims of liability for any injury or loss sustained at a TVS function. TVS will not share information with anyone except as detailed in our Privacy Policy (<http://www.trivalleystargazers.org/privacy.shtml>).

Mail this completed form along with a check to: Tri-Valley Stargazers, P.O. Box 2476, Livermore, CA 94551.